

Chapter 42-6

The Daoist temple had flourishing incense offerings. The cauldron in front of the main hall was filled with incense sticks, wisps of smoke drifting toward the sky, and devout worshippers knelt on prayer mats.

As soon as she arrived at the temple, Liang Shi excused herself to use the restroom and separated from the others.

Many people treated this place as a tourist attraction, and it was indeed quite modernized.

One courtyard even had a large tree with lush branches and leaves, hung with wooden plaques, red cloth strips, and tied lovers' knots—many people's wishes hanging there.

After many years, this place had long since become different from what Liang Shi had seen in her dreams, but standing at the temple's best vantage point for viewing the scenery, it was about eighty percent similar to what Liang Shi had previously seen in her dreams.

With limited time, she went directly to find the temple's management personnel, "Excuse me, is Daoist Master Yunyin¹ here?"

The other person wore gray robes and, after looking Liang Shi up and down, replied: "Our Daoist Master travels the four directions, with no fixed return date. This benefactor should come another day."

"Is there any way to contact him?" Liang Shi asked: "I have urgent business with him."

"Everyone who comes here has urgent business." The other replied: "But the Daoist Master has been traveling for many years, rarely returning home. We don't know his whereabouts."

His voice was unhurried, speaking slowly, giving Liang Shi a headache.

She couldn't tell if he was playing taiji² with her or if the Daoist Master really wasn't there.

Liang Shi asked: "What about your Daoist Master's phone number?"

The other: "..."

Liang Shi was surprised: "He can't possibly not have a phone, right? You don't all communicate by brain waves, do you? Carrier pigeons?"

The other: "..."

"Well, there is one." The other said: "However, our Daoist Master's whereabouts are always uncertain, and he rarely turns on his phone. Moreover, many people seek him out, so we never reveal the Daoist Master's contact information. You should wait until he returns from his travels before asking."

Liang Shi: "..."

Anyway, it was just one sentence: not giving it.

Liang Shi held onto one last hope, "Can you perform sacrificial rituals?"

The other looked completely baffled: "What do you mean?"

"Using people as sacrifices to exchange for certain things." Liang Shi said.

The other was horrified, "Benefactor, this is a proper place. We never engage in illegal business. What you're saying sounds so sinister!"

Liang Shi: "..."

It seemed he truly didn't know. Liang Shi gave up and left her phone number with him.

When the other asked for her name, she hesitated for a moment, then said: "My name is Xu Qingzhu."

She was afraid that if the Daoist Master Yunyin knew her name, he would contact Qiu Zimin first.

So she gave Xu Qingzhu's name instead.

The other noted it down, "Alright, when the Daoist Master returns, I will definitely contact you."

Afterward, the other also said: "Our temple also provides fortune-telling, matchmaking, and other services. You can check out the Tianji Pavilion³ for specifics."

Liang Shi agreed.

Then she contacted Li Ran and the others, and together they went to the main hall to pray for peace talismans.

While praying, she asked for several more, getting them for Xu Qingzhu, Liang Xinhe, Sun Meirou, and Ling Dang.

Originally, she hadn't planned to get them for others, but remembering that Xu Qingzhu said Big Brother had also stood up for her that night, she got one for Liang Xinzhou as well.

Then she thought of Zhao Xuning in the hospital, where medical disputes could easily occur, so she got one for Zhao Xuning too.

After that, she thought of Zhao Ying, who had always supported her, so she got one for Zhao Ying as well.

In the end, she got so many that everyone exclaimed, "Are you here for wholesale?"

Liang Shi was helpless, "Can't help it, too many people to give them to."

Since Li Ran had gotten one for Zhou Li, she didn't get one for her.

Liang Shi had thought of every person around her who was good to her. After getting the peace talismans, they all went to Tianji Pavilion together.

Walking along the way, Li Ran said: "If they really could reveal heavenly secrets, these people would definitely have the five disadvantages and three deficiencies⁴, right?"

"What if it's real?" A female colleague said: "My friend said the fortune-telling here is very accurate."

Li Ran: "That's also true. Since we're already here."

Liang Shi came with a neutral attitude. Previously, she indeed didn't believe in these things much.

But now, she felt there might be something to it after all.

Footnotes: ¹ Daoist Master Yunyin: "Cloud Hidden" Daoist Master, the mysterious religious figure who may have performed the ritual involving the original Liang Shi ² Taiji: The practice of being evasive or non-committal in conversation, literally referring to the philosophical concept of yin and yang ³ Tianji Pavilion: "Heavenly Secrets Pavilion" where fortune-telling services are provided ⁴ Five disadvantages and three deficiencies: Traditional Chinese belief that those who reveal heavenly secrets will suffer from various misfortunes in life as punishment